Design Journal6

Assignments Shooter

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Concept Statement

My inspiration was gained from a game called space shooter in my childhood. And now I made a university version called assignments shooter. Professors will send out assignments and I collect brain as my bullets and send back my works to fulfill the tasks. The backgroud is our campus. That would be more immersive. Besides, I made it into two modes which based on different rules. It would add more playability and enjoyment.

Inspiration





Generative rules



Game Starting Point

Once the game is launched, the player will see a main menu with two options: "Challenge Mode" and "Score Mode".Then, the rule will be shown on the screen.
Enemies spawn randomly from the top of the screen and move towards the player.
The player starts with 3 lives (score mode) or 5 lives (challenge mode), and 10 bullets.

Game Objects

- Challenge Mode:

Players need to reach the target score within a specified time.The target score and time for each level increase gradually:
Level 1: Target 10 minutes, time 30 seconds.
Level 2: Target 30 minutes, time 40 seconds.
Subsequent levels: The target score is increased by 20 points per level, and the time is fixed at 30 seconds.

- Scoring mode:

The player has 3 lives and no time limit.
The goal is to get the highest possible score.
The game ends after the life is exhausted, and the player can view the final score and the highest score.

Game Rules

- Player Rules:

Use the keyboard (WASD or arrow keys) to control the ship's movement.
Press the space bar to fire bullets, which are limited in number and can be replenished by collecting bullet resources.
Players lose their lives when they collide with enemies or enemy bullets, and the game ends when the lives are exhausted.

- Enemy rules:

Enemies spawn randomly from the top of the screen and move down.
Enemies will randomly fire bullets at the player.
When a player's bullet hits an enemy, the enemy is destroyed and the player's score increases.

- Resource rules:

Bullet resources appear randomly on the screen, and players can replenish the number of bullets after collecting them.
Victory condition:

- Challenge Mode: Reach the target score within the specified time.
- Scoring mode: Get the highest possible score.
- Failure condition:
  Life depletion (Challenge mode or score mode).
  In Challenge mode, the target score is not reached within the specified time.

Core Mechanics and Loop

- Core mechanics:

Move and Shoot: The player controls the movement of the ship and fires bullets to destroy enemies.
Resource management: The number of bullets is limited, and players need to use and collect resources wisely.
Life Management: Players need to avoid colliding with enemies or enemy bullets and maintain health.

- Game loop:

The player enters the game and selects the mode.
The player controls the movement of the ship, eliminating enemies and collecting resources.
In Challenge mode, the player needs to reach the target score within a specified time; In scoring mode, players need to get as high a score as possible.
After the game is over, the player can choose to restart or return to the main menu.

Anticipated player experience



- Tense and exciting battle:

The random generation of enemies and bullets makes the game challenging, requiring quick reactions and precise manipulation.With a limited number of bullets, players need to use resources wisely and increase strategy.

- Diverse experiences:

Challenge mode and score mode offer different game experiences to meet the needs of different players.
The Free mode offers the player an opportunity for unlimited challenges.

- Easy to learn, difficult to master:

The rules of the game are simple and intuitive, and novice players can quickly get started.As the level increases in difficulty, players need to continuously improve their skills and strategies to increase the depth of the game.

Outcome

Iterative process

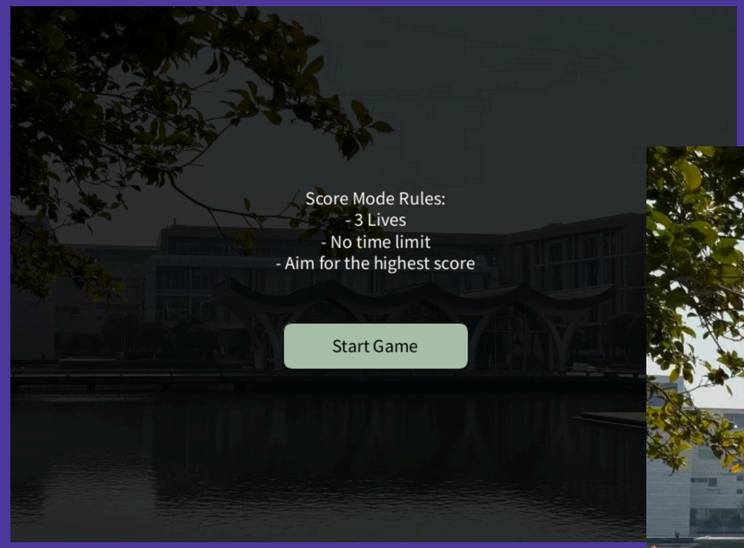
First iteration: Adding game modes and objectives
The second iteration: Adding resources and strategies
The third iteration: Optimizing the visuals and narrative
Fourth iteration: Adding the game end interface and mode switching
Fifth iteration: Zoom in on ICONS and refine details

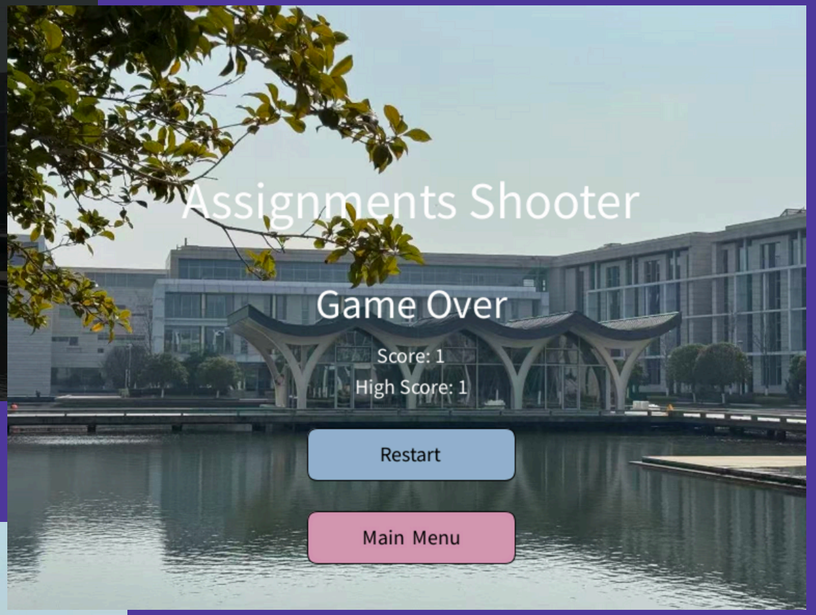
Improvements after the showcase

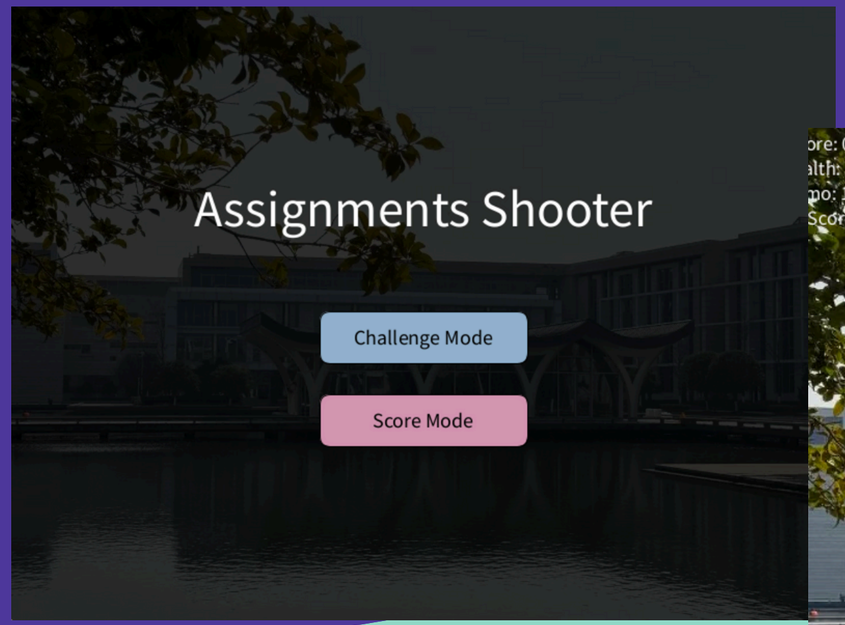
1.After the user test, I add one ‘health’ to Challenge Mode(5 in total), which can increase the playability.
2.Rules will be shown before player starts the game.
3.Change the color and the shape of the button to make it look better. And change the background into dark color to show the text clearly.
4.Change the rate of ammo’s refreshing to add difficulties.
5.Add more levels and rounds in Challenge Mode.
6.Add sound when player hits the professor(sorry) and when player is hit by the professor using the assignments.



Outcome


Score Mode Rules:
- 3 Lives
- No time limit
- Aim for the highest score
Start Game


Assignments Shooter
Game Over
Score: 1
High Score: 1
Restart
Main Menu


Assignments Shooter
Challenge Mode
Score Mode


ore: 0
alth: 3
mo: 15
Score: 0